

Proposal XML for Television

Functional Requirements

Proposal XML for Television	1
Project.....	2
Scope.....	2
Context/Background.....	2
General Requirement	2
Generic Document Information.....	2
Proposal Requirements.....	3
Proposal Properties.....	3
Avail Lists.....	5
Avail Lines.....	6
Additional Sales Data	8
Revision Requirements	9
How Receiving System May Handle Revisions	9
Appendix.....	10
<i>Glossary of Terms</i>	10
<i>Technical XML Clarifications</i>	11
<i>Frequently Asked Questions</i>	12

Project

Proposal XML for Television

Scope

This document describes the requirements for transmitting XML proposal information for Spot TV and Spot Cable. Proposals are transmitted from the seller to the buyer via email in an XML attachment.

Context/Background

The new XML file replaces the existing TV Avail Manager (TAM) format with an improved format being proposed to the industry as a standard. In addition, the new XML file has the following enhancements:

- the ability to include spots scheduled by week, by day, or by total number
- the ability to include multiple avail lists in a single proposal
- the ability to clearly specify program availability
- the ability to include additional sales information
- the ability to send updated proposals

General Requirement

The basic requirement is that the XML file must contain the necessary information in order for it to be useful between buyers and sellers. This includes generic document information for pre-processing along with proposal-specific data. Each XML file contains one proposal.

Generic Document Information

Every XML file must contain the following generic document information. This information can be used by a pre-processor to validate the XML against the appropriate version of the schema and to route the document to the appropriate receiving system.

- Schema name: The schema name identifies the name of the schema against which the document should be validated, e.g., SpotTVCableProposal.
- Schema version: The schema version identifies the version of the schema against which the document should be validated, e.g., 1.0.0.0.
- Media: The media identifies the type of media the document is for, e.g., Spot TV, Spot Cable. Any stations included on the document must be consistent with the specified media; i.e., if the media is Spot Cable, the document must only include cable stations.
- Business object: The business object identifies the type of object the document represents, e.g., Proposal.

- Action: The action indicates the high level intent of the sender, e.g., whether this is a new document or a revision. For a new document, the action should be “New.” For a revised document, the action should be “Revised.”
- Unique message identifier: The intent of the global unique identifier is to uniquely identify each document transmission and should be different even if the same document is retransmitted. Although an entry is required in this field, due to the current delivery method, the identifier is not used for tracking proposal transmissions. Therefore, the sender can enter a unique or dummy value, which the receiver may choose to ignore.

Proposal Requirements

Every proposal must include:

- a set of general properties that applies to the entire proposal
- one or more avail lists

A proposal may also include one or more pieces of additional sales information.

Proposal Properties

The following information is required on every proposal:

- Seller information: The seller information identifies the source of the proposal and must include the names of the company and salesperson. It may also include the seller’s contact information and sales office name.
- Buyer information: The buyer information identifies the recipient of the proposal and must include the agency name. It may also include the buyer’s name and agency office name.
- Start/End date: The start and end dates apply to all information included in the proposal and can fall on any day of the week.
- Week start day: The week start day defines the start of the week as it relates to scheduling spots within the proposal; the receiving prebuy system uses the week start day to interpret the number of weeks in a proposal and how spots are distributed. Because the proposal can be generated for standard broadcast weeks (i.e., Monday-Sunday) or non-standard weeks (i.e., out-of-week rotators), the week start day can be any day of the week.

- Station information: The station information identifies the stations that will air the proposed programming in the avail lists; all stations on the proposal must fall within a single media, broadcast television or cable, and a single market and must be represented by the seller. For broadcast television, each station is defined by its call letters and a parent-plus yes/no attribute. For cable, the station is typically defined by its syscode and network code, although it is possible to define the station just by syscode.
- Proposal ID: The seller must assign an ID to each proposal. Because this ID is used to track the proposal history and to associate any revisions, it must be unique to the seller, must remain the same for all versions of this piece of business, and cannot be reused on any subsequent proposals. This field accepts any string value; the seller determines the format of the ID.
- Proposal name: The seller must assign a name to each proposal, e.g., "2006 4th Quarter Rates for Station WAAA."
- Version: The version is an increasing positive integer value used to sequence proposal revisions. Although version values do not need to be consecutive, the version for the first send of a proposal, i.e., a new proposal, should be set to one. Only a seller change to the proposal results in a new version; the highest value indicates the most current version of the proposal.
- Send date and time: The send date and time indicate when this version of the proposal was transmitted from the seller to the buyer.

The following information is optional:

- Seller reference: This can be any additional identifier the seller decides to include on the proposal, e.g., the contract number. The seller reference is not required to be unique.
- Product information: The product information identifies the product for which the buyer is ordering. When in use, it must include the product name. In the case of piggybacks, two product allocations paired on one spot, the product information must include the names of the paired products.
- Advertiser information: The advertiser information identifies the client for whom the buyer is ordering and must include the advertiser name. It can be included on any proposal but is required if product information is included in the proposal.

Avail Lists

The avail list identifies a group of avails available for the buyer to upload into a prebuy system. An avail list must contain at least one avail line.

The following information is required on every avail list:

- Station information: The station information is a subset of stations from the proposal. It defines the stations offering programming for this avail list and may include a comment for each station.
- Start/End date: The avail list must include the earliest period start date and the latest period end date. These dates must fall within the start and end dates of the proposal.
- Avail list identifier: The seller must assign an identifier to each avail list. The avail list identifier is used to identify the list of programs and must be unique only within the proposal. The identifier can be any string value.
- Avail list name: The seller must assign a name to each avail list in the proposal, e.g., "WCBS Q407."
- Package flag: This is a required yes/no value that indicates whether the avail list is being offered as a package.

The following information is optional:

- Demo information: The avail list may contain up to 20 demographic categories, one of which may be designated as the primary demo. The demos are defined at the list level to ensure consistency across avails. Each demo category must include:
 - Demo type: rating or impression
 - Demo group: adults, men, women, working women, teens, children, persons, or homes
 - Age from: the starting age for the demo, from the Nielsen standard list
 - Age to: the ending age for the demo, from the Nielsen standard list
- Sales information reference: The avail list may include a reference to one piece of additional sales information. Although a proposal may contain multiple pieces of sales information, each avail list can only include one reference; therefore, the reference should be to sales information associated directly with this avail list, e.g., reach and frequency values.
- General comments: The list may include general seller comments, e.g., comments related to a market or schedule.

Avail Lines

The following details are required for every avail line on the avail list:

- Station information: The station information identifies the station offering the programming for the avail line. The station must be from the list of stations on the avail list.
- Days/Times: Each avail line must include the days of the week and the start and end times the programming airs. Times are expressed in broadcast-day time (for more information, see the Glossary at the end of this document), days as a list of yes/no values. Each avail line must have at least one active day and one start/end time assigned. For avail lines with multiple programs, e.g., orbits, an optional program name may be included for each day/time combination.
- Avail description: Each avail line must include a description of the avail being offered, e.g., programming description, orbit description, etc.
- Length: Each avail line must include the spot length represented in units of hours, minutes and seconds. The format is HH:MM:SS, where HH is the number hours, MM is the number of minutes, and SS is the number of seconds.
- Available periods, rates, spots, and demos: All avail lines must include at least one period and one rate and may include spots and/or demos.
 - Available periods: Available periods define the dates during which the seller is offering the avail line. Each available period is a range of dates defined by a start date and an end date that falls within the start and end dates of the avail list. The available periods on an avail line cannot overlap dates or broadcast weeks.
 - Rates: The rate is always the cost per spot. No-charge spots should be entered with a \$0 rate.
 - Spots (optional): A schedule of spots may be included.
 - Demo values (optional): Demo values may be included for the demo categories on the avail list. The demo value must be in the appropriate format: one- or two-decimal number for ratings; whole number for impressions.

The available periods, rates, spots, and demos must be set up in one of the following formats. All avail lines in a single avail list must be of the same format.

Format 1 – Allows for a different rate, number of spots, and set of demo values for each period.

A rate is required for each available period. For every period on the line, *either* a number of spots per week *or* a number of spots by day can be included; i.e., the same avail line cannot contain a period with spots per week and a period with spots per day. For each period, a demo value for each demo category may also be included.

- Example 1: A different rate, number of spots per week, and rating for each period; each period is one week.

				Daypart					
Station	Days	Time	Program Name	Name	Len	Period 1	Period 2	Period 3	
YAAA	M-F	10a-11a	Talk Show	Daytime	30	4/16-4/22	4/23-4/29	4/30-5/6	
					Spots/week	3	5	4	
					Rate per spot	\$1,500.00	\$2,000.00	\$3,000.00	
					RAD2554	5.0	5.5	6.0	
					RHOMES	4.5	5	5.5	

- Example 2: A different rate, number of spots per day, and rating for each period.

				Daypart					
Station	Days	Time	Program Name	Name	Len	Period 1	Period 2	Period 3	
YAAA	M-F	10a-11a	Talk Show	Daytime	30	4/16-4/22	4/23-4/29	4/30-May 6	
					Spots/day				
					M		1		
					Tu		2		
					W	2	1	2	
					Th	3	2	1	
					F	1	1	2	
					Rate per spot	\$1,500.00	\$2,000.00	\$3,000.00	
					RAD2554	5.5	4.0	4.5	
					RHOMES	5.0	5.5	6.0	

- Example 3: A different number of spots per week for each period; rate and ratings are the same for each period.

				Daypart					
Station	Days	Time	Program Name	Name	Len	Period 1	Period 2		
1234/XYZ	M-F	10a-11a	Talk Show	Daytime	30	4/16-4/29	5/7-5/20		
					Spots/week	3	5		
					Rate per spot	\$1,500.00	\$1,500.00		
					RAD2554	5.0	5.0		
					RHOMES	6.0	6.0		

Format 2 – Allows for a single rate, total number of spots, and set of demo values that apply to all periods.

The line includes a single rate that applies across all available periods. The line may include a total number of spots across all periods and may also include a demo value for each demo category that applies to all periods.

- Example 1: A single rate, total number of spots and a set of ratings across periods.

				Daypart				Demo	Demo		
Station	Days	Time	Program Name	Name	Len	Total Spots	Rate per spot	RWM2554	RHOMES	Period 1	Period 2
YAAA	M-F	8p-11p	Olympics	Prime	30	45	\$1,000.00	7.0	7.5	2/13-2/17	2/20-2/24

The following details are optional:

- Daypart name: The avail line may include the daypart name used by the seller. This is for informational purposes only. The receiving system will not use the seller dayparts, as they may differ from the buyers’.
- Comment: The avail line may include additional comments from the seller.

Additional Sales Data

The seller may choose to send supporting information with the proposal; for example the seller might include additional research on program trends, reach and frequency based on the schedule, or other sales information. The supporting information must be sent as HTML embedded in the XML document. The HTML markup must be well-formed and cannot contain any scripts, Java applications, Flash, or embedded content.

To ensure security, the prebuy system should initially display the sales information to the buyer with images and external links disabled. The buyer should then be prompted for approval to trust the site in order to display any images or external links.

Each piece of sales information must be assigned a name to identify it, e.g., “Rates and Frequency Q407.”

Revision Requirements

A revision is a proposal that is being re-sent with changes; i.e., a revision is the most current version of a proposal. The seller cannot send just the changes but must re-send the *entire* proposal with changes. A revision may include, for example, updated rates and programming changes. The proposal with the highest version is the newest revision.

How Receiving System May Handle Revisions

The combination of the Proposal ID, which identifies the piece of business between the seller and the buyer, and the Avail List Identifier, which identifies the list of avails within the proposal, can be used by the receiving system to process revision data. The buyer initially imports avail lines from specific avail lists in the proposal into a prebuy system. As the seller sends revisions, the buyer may also need to revise the imported prebuy data. The combination of proposal and avail list identifiers allows the revision data to be associated with the prebuy data in order for comparisons and other workflow enhancements to be achieved.

Appendix

Glossary of Terms

Avail: An avail is a day and time period combination available for sale, also known as “available inventory.” In the case of orbits, an avail may include multiple days and times.

Broadcast-day time: Broadcast-day time is a modified version of the 30-hour notation used to represent the entire broadcast day. This modified notation supports broadcast days that start either at 5 or 6 AM and extend into the next calendar day. Broadcast-day time is similar to military time except that it adds 24 hours to broadcast times that cross into the next calendar day.

For a broadcast day that starts at 5 AM, the broadcast-day time is 05:00 for 5 AM, 24:00 for midnight, and 28:59 for 4:59 AM the following day. For convenience, 29:00 may be used to refer to 5 AM the following day. For example, when referring to the end of the broadcast day in a time interval, 28:00-29:00 represents 4 AM-5 AM the following day.

For a broadcast day that starts at 6 AM, the broadcast-day time is 06:00 for 6 AM, 24:00 for midnight, and 29:59 for 5:59 AM the following day. For convenience, 30:00 may be used to refer to 6 AM the following day. For example, when referring to the end of the broadcast day in a time interval, 29:00-30:00 represents 5 AM-6 AM the following day.

Orbit: An orbit is a group of programs sold as one time period. Spots are distributed across the orbit and are not assigned to any of the specific programs.

Package: An avail list that is being offered for purchase as a whole; i.e., the seller is not offering individual lines, but a group of avail lines to be purchased together.

Technical XML Clarifications

XML Schema IDs and IDREFs: The ID/IDREF XML Schema mechanism is used throughout the Proposal XML Schema to uniquely identify a piece of information and then reference this information elsewhere in the XML document. The value of the identifier has no business value and is generated specifically for the particular instance of the document.

Below is sample XML showing how this mechanism is used. The demo category in the avail list is identified by the **Demold** attribute. The demo category is then referenced by a demo value element on the avail line using the **demoRef** attribute.

```
<AvailList identifier="AL001" startDate="2007-04-16" endDate="2007-06-24" isPackage="N">
...
  <DemoCategories>
    <DemoCategory Demold="DM0">
      <tvb:DemoType>Rating</tvb:DemoType>
      <tvb:Group>Adults</tvb:Group>
      <tvb:AgeFrom>25</tvb:AgeFrom>
      <tvb:AgeTo>54</tvb:AgeTo>
    </DemoCategory>
  </DemoCategories>
  ...
  <AvailLineWithPeriods>
    ...
    <DemoValues>
      <DemoValue demoRef="DM0">5.0</DemoValue>
```

Frequently Asked Questions

How do I send an orbit?

To indicate that you are sending an orbit, you should include all the day/time combinations of the orbit in the **Days/Times** element on the avail line, and for each day/time, you may include an optional Program Name. You should also enter an orbit description in the **Avail Description** element on the avail line, e.g., Prime Orbit, News Orbit.

What about a demo value for the orbit?

The demo value of the orbit as a whole may be included in the **Demo** element on the avail line. Demo values for each program within the orbit may be sent as additional sales information.

How do I send a package?

To indicate that you are sending the avail list a package, you must set the **isPackage** attribute to **Y**.

How does the XML support 'Daily' Buys?

For daily buys, set up your **Available periods, rates, spots, and demos** element using Format 1 with spots scheduled by day. You can schedule spots by day even if the avail line is set up for a rotation of days, e.g., M-F.

How much additional sales information can be included in the proposal? Is it only one reference per avail list?

A proposal may contain multiple pieces of sales information, but each avail list can only include one sales information reference. However, a single html file can contain extensive data, e.g., multiple tables, lists of additional demos, reach and frequency values, etc.

How do I send comments?

Comments can be entered on the proposal at three different levels. For each avail list, you have the option to include station comments as part of the station information, and you may include seller comments that apply to the avail list as a whole in the general comments for the list. For each avail line, you can set up seller comments specific to the line.

How does the XML support non-standard broadcast weeks?

In addition to the start and end dates of the proposal, a “start day” of the week must be assigned. This start day controls how broadcast weeks are defined within the proposal, as well as how spots per week are distributed.

For example, if the start day is Wednesday, weeks within the proposal are defined as Wednesday-Tuesday. If the avail starts on a day other than Wednesday, the first week of the avail will be a partial week; i.e., if the avail starts on a Monday, the first week will be Mon-Tues. If the avail ends on a day other than Tuesday, the last week of the avail will be a partial week; i.e., if the avail ends on a Sunday, the last week will be Wed-Sun. To be sure spots are distributed appropriately in partial weeks, you should set up the partial weeks as separate available periods.

Avail Example: Consider an avail offer for daytime programming that runs Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, and Friday. The avail is for five spots per week at \$300 per spot, available 4/9/07-4/29/07.

With a week start day of Monday and a single available period 4/9/07-4/29/07, spots would be distributed as follows, for a total of 15 spots and a total cost of \$4500.

- Week 1: 4/9-4/13 (Mon, Tue, Wed, Thu, Fri); five spots at \$300 per spot
- Week 1: 4/16-4/20 (Mon, Tue, Wed, Thu, Fri); five spots at \$300 per spot
- Week 2: 4/23-4/27 (Mon, Tue, Wed, Thu, Fri); five spots at \$300 per spot

With a week start day of Wednesday and a single available period 4/9/07-4/29/07, spots would be distributed as follows, for a total of 20 spots and a total cost of \$6000:

- Week 1 (partial): 4/9-4/10 (Mon, Tue); five spots at \$300 per spot
- Week 2: 4/11-4/13, 4/16-4/17 (Wed, Thu, Fri, Mon, Tue); five spots at \$300 per spot
- Week 3: 4/18-4/20, 4/23-4/24 (Wed, Thu, Fri, Mon, Tue); five spots at \$300 per spot
- Week 4 (partial): 4/25-4/27 (Wed, Thu, Fri); five spots at \$300 per spot

With a week start day of Wednesday and three available periods 4/9-4/10/07, 4/11-4/24/07, and 4/25-4/27/07, spots could be distributed as follows, for a total of 15 spots and a total cost of \$4500:

- Period 1, 4/9-4/10/07
 - Week 1 (partial): 4/9-4/10: (Mon, Tue); two spots at \$300 per spot
- Period 2, 4/11-4/24
 - Week 1: 4/11-4/17 (Wed, Thu, Fri, Mon, Tue); five spots at \$300 per spot
 - Week 2: 4/18-4/24 (Wed, Thu, Fri, Mon, Tue); five spots at \$300 per spot
- Period 3, 4/25-4/27
 - Week 1 (partial): 4/25-4/27 (Wed, Thu, Fri); three spots at \$300 per spot